World Health Organization
African Region

MEC 2026 | DAY 2 | BLOCK A | POLICY BRIEF P2

Performance evidence standard

Paper MEC-09, policy P2 of 7, for decision

Friday 20 November 2026, Session 3, 10:45–11:45 | Block A. Performance and evidence | For decision

Draft of 4 November 2026 for TWG review. Parameters such as deadlines, response times and thresholds not set by the Framework are proposals, shown as such in the decision options.

The policy in brief

Every P/S rating rests on evidence that can be checked: completion and contribution cite their evidence, the reliability of each figure is stated, financial figures come from corporate systems, and MSC verifies a sample each cycle.

Why this policy

Products and services are the operational entry gate of the system: what WHO directly delivers, and the level at which performance can be managed most directly. Every decision about delivery, and every account of results given to Member States, inherits the quality of the P/S ratings beneath it.

SAM1 2026 produced ratings for 1,336 priority P/S, but almost none can be traced to evidence. This policy sets the standard each rating must meet before it is signed off.

What the evidence shows

- **1 of 1,336** P/S assessments cites an evidence source, and that entry is a placeholder.
- **255 of 1,276** rated figures (20%) are estimated or unavailable rather than confirmed.
- **105** country P/S rated on track reported less than 30% progress at the September 2026 export, eight and a half months into the 24-month biennium; **29** P/S rated on track carry an at-risk or off-track risk flag.
- **64 of 459** P/S with a utilisation rate report spending more than 150% of budget; planned cost is missing for 607 P/S.

Scope

All P/S assessments of the 47 Country Offices and the six Regional Office budget centres in SAM, the MTR and EOB reporting, and the P/S data used in the monthly WR-led review.

The policy

1. **Six metrics.** P/S performance is assessed against the six metrics of the Framework: delivery completion, timeliness, quality, reach or coverage, utilization and contribution to output (Framework, Part VI.3). Until Annex H sets the data fields, the SAM1 assessment form applies, with the fields this policy adds.
2. **Ratings cite their evidence.** A rating of “completed” cites the evidence that the deliverable exists, such as the document, dataset or event record. A rating of “strong contribution” cites the evidence that the P/S advanced its output, such as use by the intended audience, an observed change or confirmation by the government or a partner. A rating without cited evidence is recorded as unverified and is not counted as completed or strong in regional reports.
3. **Reliability is stated.** Every figure is marked confirmed, estimated or unavailable. An estimate states its basis.
4. **Status and progress agree.** Where the delivery status, the progress reported and the risk flag point in different directions, the office explains the difference or corrects the rating before sign-off. The platform flags these cases.
5. **Financial figures come from corporate systems.** Planned cost, funded amount and expenditure are taken from the SPM and GSM, not entered by hand. Until the platform draws on them directly (Annex G, Phase 3), MSC supplies the extract for each cycle. Utilisation above 150% is reviewed with the budget and finance officer before sign-off.

6. **Data quality assurance.** Each office documents the sources of its decision-critical indicators and runs a data quality assessment on them at least once a year, recording their reliability (Annex C, Domain 4).
7. **Monthly use.** P/S delivery is reviewed in the monthly WR-led performance and learning review, at cluster level each quarter, and in SAM, the MTR and EOB reporting (Framework, Part VI.4).
8. **Verification sample.** Each cycle, MSC checks a random sample of 10% of the "completed" and "strong contribution" ratings across the Region against the cited evidence, covering every budget centre at least once a year, and reports the share confirmed. Ratings not confirmed are returned for correction before regional consolidation. The WR's sign-off certifies that the office's ratings rest on the evidence cited.

Who does what

Programme leads	Rate their P/S and cite the evidence.
MEAL focal point	Checks evidence and consistency before sign-off; runs the annual data quality assessment.
WHO Representative or budget centre director	Signs off the ratings, certifying the evidence; uses P/S data in the monthly review.
MSC Unit	Issues the evidence guidance; supplies the SPM and GSM extracts; runs the verification sample and reports its results.
Regional Office clusters	Review the P/S in their area each quarter.

Timeline

When	Milestone
1 Jan 2027	Standard applies to every assessment
31 Mar 2027	Evidence guidance with examples by type of P/S; evidence and consistency fields on the platform
SAM1 2027	First cycle with pre-filled financial figures and the verification sample
31 Dec 2027	Every office has run one data quality assessment
MEC 2027	First report on verification results

How compliance is measured

Indicator	Baseline	Target
"Completed" and "strong contribution" ratings citing evidence	0% (SAM1 2026)	At least 90% in SAM1 2027; 100% from 2028
Rated figures that are confirmed	80% (1,021 of 1,276)	90% by 2028
Sampled ratings confirmed by verification	Not yet measured	At least 90%
Offices with an annual data quality assessment	Not yet measured	47 by 31 December 2027

Decision options

Option	What the MEC would adopt	Implications
A Recommended	**Standard as proposed, for Country Offices and Regional Office budget centres from January 2027**	Ratings reported for the 2026–2027 biennium can be checked; adds a verification workload for MSC each cycle.
B	Evidence required for "completed" only; contribution evidence from 2028	Lighter start, but contribution claims in the end-of-biennium report stay unverifiable.
C	Guidance only, without the verification sample	No added cost, but no assurance on the figures reported to Member States.

Resources

MSC time for the verification sample each cycle and platform changes for the evidence and consistency fields. Costed in paper MEC-10.

> **The MEC is asked to**
>
> Adopt the performance evidence standard for all budget centres from 1 January 2027 (option A).

Framework references: Framework Parts VI and X.1; Annex C, Domains 4 and 5; Annex E; Annex G, Modules 1, 2 and 4; Annexes H and J (not in this package). Domains: D4 Data systems, D5 Monitoring, D7 Analytics.